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<https://russelldudek.github.io/Vontier/>

Operator-technologist who makes complex work visible and turns emerging technology into adopted operating systems. Combines industrial hardware/software leadership, AI workflow design, distributed operations, quality systems, and customer-facing innovation to move ideas from practical proof to measurable production value.

EXPERIENCE

Vape-Jet

2025-Present

Director of Operations

- Lead AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.
- Connect factory, field, customer, and machine-fleet signals into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, cleaner handoffs, dashboards, standard work, training, and accountability.
- Operate in a software-enabled robotics and machine-vision environment with approximately 1,000 fielded robots informing support and operating feedback loops.

DudeWorth

2017-Present

Founder / AI and Automation Advisor

- Develop AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks assessing value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- Design agentic workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, AI agents, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.
- Advise on AI-enabled operations, logistics technology, warehouse automation, AMRs, ASRS, cobots, transportation systems, network analysis, and workflow design.

Amazon

2014-2018

Operations Management / Site Leader

- Led launch and execution for Amazon Prime Pittsburgh in a 24/7 customer-backward environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation paths, standard work, and operating mechanisms; applied Lean and Gemba across safety, quality, throughput, customer experience, and engagement.
- Served on the Amazon Prime Now launch team with Whole Foods and contributed to logistics innovation concepts.

ROLE-ALIGNED VALUE

- AI portfolio and operating-system design
- Industrial hardware/software bridge
- Distributed launch and adoption
- VBS-compatible continuous improvement
- Customer and field signal integration
- Governance without innovation drag

TECHNICAL TOOLKIT

Agentic AI, LLM workflows, RAG patterns, human-in-the-loop design, Python, SQL, JavaScript, TensorFlow, Tableau, ERP/Odoo, Jira, Confluence, HubSpot, Slack, GIS and mapping workflows.

CREDENTIALS

- Google AI Essentials
- Food Safety Management Certification
- IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner
- Six Sigma Certification
- OSHA 10

INDUSTRIAL SYSTEMS

Advanced electronics, robotics, machine vision, autonomous systems, quality, and field operations.

OPERATING MECHANISMS

Lean and Gemba, standard work, root cause, escalation, adoption, and executive cadence.

DIRECT AI EXECUTION

Readiness models, agentic workflows, retrieval, human review, evaluation, and governance.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Compunetics

2000-2013

Director of Operations and Engineering Management

- Progressed through R&D program management, production management, strategic acquisition, operations management, and director-level leadership.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs in advanced electronics and high-reliability environments.
- Built quality systems, standard work, root-cause practices, performance measures, and process controls; collaborated with high-consequence partners including DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD.
- Published industry articles, delivered technical talks, and participated in the HyperTransport Consortium.

Cardinal Building Products

2021-2023

Regional Director

- Built the company's first remote regional operation and modernized distributed customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, digital marketing, SEO, and online-buying workflows.
- Advanced AI-enhanced transportation-management and route-planning concepts.

ZeusVu

2018-2022

Chief Pilot, Autonomous Systems and Aerial Data Operations

- Led regulated drone operations across medical, energy, logistics, real-estate, and restricted-airspace contexts with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.
- Developed TensorFlow-based concepts for automated aerial inventory and computer-vision-enabled field intelligence.
- Designed medical drone delivery and chain-of-custody concepts connecting technology, risk, stakeholders, and governed execution.

Enviro Social Capital

2014-2017

Chairman of the Board

- Co-founded and led a public-private impact initiative focused on sustainable infrastructure, green finance, and civic transformation.
- Helped shape and evaluate a \$200 million Social Impact Bond feasibility concept for Pittsburgh sewage and green-infrastructure improvement.

IEEE

2012-2016

CMPT and EDS Pittsburgh Chapter Chair

- Led regional technology programming connecting industry, academia, STEM outreach, electronics, manufacturing, and emerging technology.

EDUCATION

University of Pittsburgh

Bachelor of Science

Academic grounding includes materials science, physical chemistry, and biology-related studies.

Academic work is indexed through the public Google Scholar profile listed above.

VONTIER THESIS

Innovation creates motion only when the enterprise can transmit it.

Build an AI operating system that couples outside-in demand with VBS discipline, explicit evidence, human authority, production architecture, adoption ownership, and reusable learning.

LEADERSHIP MECHANISMS

- Portfolio intake and prioritization
- Cross-functional governance
- Standard work and playbooks
- Quality and root-cause systems
- Executive operating cadence
- Frontline coaching and adoption
- Vendor and ecosystem coordination

CANDIDATE VISION

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